

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 10

APUSH-SAQ10-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of World War I argues that federal restrictions on speech and dissent reflected the demands of wartime mobilization. According to this interpretation, officials feared that antiwar organizing, labor unrest, and foreign propaganda could weaken military recruitment, war production, and national unity.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of civil liberties argues that wartime restrictions during World War I revealed how quickly democratic rights could be narrowed during crisis. According to this interpretation, the government used national security arguments to suppress socialist, pacifist, immigrant, and labor voices that challenged wartime policy.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of wartime restrictions on dissent.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing wartime necessity and national unity, while Source B emphasizes suppression of civil liberties and dissent.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as World War I mobilization, the Selective Service Act, fear of sabotage, German propaganda concerns, labor unrest in war industries, or federal efforts to maintain recruitment and production.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as the Espionage Act, Sedition Act, prosecutions of socialists or pacifists, restrictions on antiwar speech, attacks on the Industrial Workers of the World, or postwar civil-liberties debates.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should recognize that wartime restrictions can be interpreted both as responses to security concerns and as limits on democratic expression. Strong responses should use specific evidence rather than simply stating that “free speech was restricted.”

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ10-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 1 — Period 1: 1491–1607

Period: Period 1: 1491–1607

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Spanish missionary writing to a colonial official after visiting Native communities in the Caribbean, 1518.

“The villages are fewer than when the first ships came, and many fields stand untended. Some people have died from sickness that arrived with us; others have fled labor demands or the taking of food. The settlers ask for more workers, saying that mines and farms must not fail. Yet I fear that a land cannot be made Christian by destroying the people one claims to instruct.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the concerns expressed in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader effects of European contact in the Americas during the sixteenth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Columbian Exchange, epidemic disease, Spanish colonization, forced labor systems, encomienda, mining, plantation agriculture, or the demographic decline of Native populations.

(b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s point of view as a missionary shaped concerns about conversion, treatment of Native peoples, labor abuses, moral responsibility, and the contradiction between Christian mission and colonial exploitation.

(c) 1 point: Explains a broader effect, such as Native population decline from disease and coercion, Spanish extraction of labor and resources, religious conversion efforts, ecological and agricultural change, the development of colonial labor systems, or the growth of transatlantic empire.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the source to the consequences of European contact without treating disease as the only factor. Strong responses should explain how disease, labor demands, religious mission, and empire-building interacted.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ10-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: MIG — Migration and Settlement

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described demographic chart created for this practice exam.

The chart is titled “Selected Changes in U.S. Immigration Patterns After 1965.”

Indicator | 1960 | 1980 | 2000

Largest immigrant-origin regions | Europe and Canada | Latin America and Asia rising | Latin America and Asia dominant

Share of immigrants settling in traditional gateway states | high | still high | high but spreading to new destinations

Common policy context | national-origins quota system still influential | post-1965 family and employment preferences | continued debates over legal status, border enforcement, and citizenship

Visible community changes | older European ethnic neighborhoods | growth of Asian American and Latino communities | multilingual schools, new suburban immigrant communities, expanded cultural institutions

The chart notes that figures are approximate and are intended to show broad demographic and policy trends.

- (a) Describe one change in U.S. immigration patterns reflected in the chart.
- (b) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the change described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one social, cultural, or political consequence of the immigration changes reflected in the chart.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as the growth of immigration from Latin America and Asia, the decline of Europe as the dominant immigrant-origin region, the spread of immigrants to new destinations, or the growth of multilingual and multicultural communities.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as the Immigration and Nationality Act of 1965, family reunification preferences, employment-based immigration, refugee policy, Cold War migration, economic opportunity, political instability abroad, or changing U.S. labor demands.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as growth of Latino and Asian American communities, debates over bilingual education, immigration reform debates, new suburban immigrant communities, cultural diversification, political mobilization around citizenship and legal status, or backlash against immigration.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect demographic change to policy and historical context. It should avoid treating post-1965 immigration as simply “more immigration” and should explain how origins, settlement patterns, community life, and politics changed.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ10-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which grassroots activism transformed the struggle for Black civil rights in the South from 1954 to 1968.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described activism map created for this practice exam, southern United States, 1954–1968.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows civil rights activity across the South, including school desegregation cases in several states, bus boycotts in Alabama, sit-ins in North Carolina and Tennessee, freedom rides across interstate bus routes, voter registration campaigns in Mississippi and Alabama, and marches in Georgia and Alabama. Symbols mark churches, colleges, courthouses, bus stations, and county registrar offices as frequent sites of organizing and conflict.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes that civil rights activism was geographically widespread and rooted in local institutions as well as national organizations.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated minutes from a local Black church committee, Montgomery, Alabama, 1956; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Organization meeting minutes.

“Drivers will continue to carry elderly workers to their jobs before sunrise. The women’s committee will collect coins for gasoline and repairs. Members agreed that the protest must remain disciplined, but several speakers reminded the group that walking to work is itself a form of testimony. The committee requested more volunteers for phone calls and childcare.”

Sourcing Cues: The minutes reflect the role of local churches, women organizers, transportation networks, and community discipline in sustained protest.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement by college students after a sit-in, Nashville, Tennessee, 1960; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Student protest statement.

“We sat at the counter because the rule was ordinary and cruel at the same time. A meal became a test of citizenship. We trained not to strike back when cursed or dragged away, but nonviolence should not be mistaken for patience with injustice.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects youth activism, nonviolent direct action, and challenges to segregation in public accommodations.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a white county official to a state legislator, Mississippi, 1962; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Government official letter.

“Outside groups are stirring up trouble among people who had lived peacefully under local custom. If federal officers force changes in registration, schools, and public facilities, local authority will be ruined. Our county cannot be governed from Washington by those who do not understand our traditions.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects white resistance, defense of local control, and opposition to federal civil rights enforcement.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Voter registration data table created for this practice exam, selected Deep South states, 1960–1968.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Black Voter Registration Trends.”

State | Approximate Black voter registration, 1960 | Approximate Black voter registration, 1968

Mississippi | very low | sharply increased

Alabama | low | substantially increased

Georgia | uneven but growing | significantly increased

Louisiana | restricted in many parishes | increased after federal enforcement

A note beneath the table states: “Registration gains varied by county, local resistance, federal enforcement, and community organizing.”

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights the connection among local activism, legal change, and voting rights enforcement.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from a Black woman voter-registration organizer, Mississippi, 1964; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Organizer testimony excerpt.

“People ask why we keep returning to the courthouse when the registrar closes the door. We return because every visit teaches someone else how the system works. A person who has been denied the ballot can still learn to organize a meeting, keep records, speak to neighbors, and refuse fear.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects grassroots organizing, local leadership, political education, and the central role of Black women in civil rights work.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Summary of federal civil rights legislation and enforcement, Washington, D.C., 1964–1965.

Source Type: Government policy summary.

Federal laws prohibited segregation in many public accommodations, strengthened federal authority against employment discrimination, and expanded federal oversight of voting practices in jurisdictions with histories of discrimination. Supporters argued that federal law was necessary because local officials had blocked constitutional rights. Opponents claimed that the laws expanded federal power too far.

Sourcing Cues: The summary reflects the relationship between grassroots protest, national political pressure, and federal enforcement.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which grassroots activism transformed the struggle for Black civil rights in the South from 1954 to 1968. The thesis must make an argument, such as that grassroots activism transformed civil rights by turning local institutions, students, women organizers, churches, and voter-registration campaigns into engines of national change, while federal action remained necessary to overcome local resistance.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as Jim Crow segregation, disfranchisement, World War II-era civil rights claims, the Great Migration’s political effects, the Cold War, school segregation, Black church networks, or earlier NAACP legal strategy.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about local organizing, church networks, women’s leadership,

student sit-ins, white resistance, voter registration, and federal enforcement.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as *Brown v. Board of Education*, Montgomery Bus Boycott, Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee, Congress of Racial Equality, Freedom Rides, Birmingham campaign, March on Washington, Freedom Summer, Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party, Selma campaign, Civil Rights Act of 1964, Voting Rights Act of 1965, or local leaders such as Ella Baker, Fannie Lou Hamer, or Septima Clark.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the church minutes as evidence of local logistical work, the student statement as youth direct-action activism, the county official's defense of local authority, the organizer testimony's grassroots political education, or the federal policy summary's response to local resistance.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that civil rights change came from the interaction of grassroots activism, national organizations, media attention, court decisions, and federal law; recognizing tensions between local leadership and national strategy; or showing that legal victories did not immediately end economic inequality, violence, or local obstruction.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that grassroots activism transformed the civil rights struggle by expanding it beyond courtroom litigation into churches, campuses, buses, lunch counters, courthouses, and local communities. Strong responses should emphasize women organizers, youth activism, Black churches, voter-registration campaigns, and local political education. At the same time, students should explain that grassroots pressure often required federal legislation and enforcement to overcome white resistance. Useful document groupings include local church organizing, student direct action, white resistance, voting-rights activism, data on registration, and federal policy responses. Relevant outside evidence could include SNCC, CORE, Freedom Rides, Freedom Summer, Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party, Selma, Civil Rights Act of 1964, or Voting Rights Act of 1965.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ10-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: MIG — Migration and Settlement

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the Louisiana Purchase through the Mexican-American War, territorial expansion reshaped the United States. Americans debated land, migration, slavery, trade, diplomacy, war, federal authority, and national destiny. Students may choose to focus on developments such as the Louisiana Purchase, migration into the Old Southwest, Texas annexation, Oregon settlement, the Mexican-American War, or the Mexican Cession.

Evaluate the most significant causes of United States territorial expansion from 1803 to 1853.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the most significant causes of United States territorial expansion from 1803 to 1853. The thesis must make a causal argument rather than simply list examples of expansion.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to expansion, such as post-Revolutionary western settlement, population growth, land hunger, plantation agriculture, commercial development, Jeffersonian ideas of an agrarian republic, rivalry with European powers, or sectional debates over slavery.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the Louisiana Purchase, Lewis and Clark expedition, War of 1812 aftermath, Adams-Onís Treaty, cotton expansion, Texas independence, Texas annexation, Oregon Trail migration, “Fifty-Four Forty or Fight,” Manifest Destiny ideology, Mexican-American War, Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo, or debates over slavery in new territories. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causes of territorial expansion.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining causation, such as showing how economic opportunity, population growth, plantation agriculture, ideology, security concerns, diplomacy, migration, and sectional politics contributed to expansion.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing between diplomatic purchase, settler migration, war, and annexation; explaining how expansion reflected both opportunity and coercion; showing how expansion united some Americans around national destiny while intensifying conflict over slavery; or recognizing the roles of foreign powers, Indigenous nations, Mexicans, settlers, enslaved people, and federal officials.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should explain why expansion occurred rather than simply narrate where the United States expanded. It might argue that territorial expansion resulted from a combination of land hunger, commercial ambition, plantation agriculture, population growth, ideology, diplomacy, and war. Strong responses should distinguish different mechanisms of expansion, such as purchase, treaty, migration, annexation, and military conquest, and should explain how expansion intensified political conflict over slavery and national identity.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ10

· APUSH-SAQ10-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; perspectives include modern secondary historians of World War I dissent restrictions as wartime national-security mobilization and as civil-liberties suppression; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast military recruitment, war production, and national unity concerns with suppression of socialist, pacifist, immigrant, and labor dissent; historical development is World War I home-front civil liberties, Espionage Act, Sedition Act, and antiwar dissent; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating wartime speech restrictions as either purely necessary security policy or purely unrelated repression without weighing mobilization context and civil-liberties costs.

· APUSH-SAQ10-002: Unit 1; Period 1: 1491–1607; perspective is Spanish missionary observing Native population decline, disease, labor demands, and colonial extraction in the Caribbean in 1518; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes missionary moral concerns, conversion, epidemic disease, forced labor, settler demands, and colonial exploitation; historical development is Columbian Exchange, Spanish colonization, Native demographic collapse, encomienda-style labor pressure, and early imperial extraction; reasoning

path is POV/purpose/audience connected to religious mission, empire, disease, labor, and demographic change; misconception targeted is treating Native population decline as caused only by disease without considering labor coercion, food disruption, missionization, and imperial demands.

- APUSH-SAQ10-003: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; perspectives include post-1965 immigrants, Latino communities, Asian American communities, policymakers, schools, suburban communities, and citizenship advocates; non-text source type is plain-text demographic chart; visual/data/map pattern is immigrant-origin shift from Europe/Canada to Latin America/Asia, gateway-state concentration with new destinations, post-1965 policy context, multilingual schools, and suburban immigrant community growth; historical development is Immigration and Nationality Act of 1965 and post-1965 demographic, cultural, and political change; reasoning path is causation linking immigration law, family/employment preferences, refugee flows, settlement patterns, and cultural/political consequences; misconception targeted is treating modern immigration as simply increased numbers rather than a major shift in origins, law, settlement, and community formation.

- APUSH-DBQ10-001: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; DBQ topic is grassroots activism transforming the Black civil rights struggle in the South from 1954 to 1968; document types include described civil rights activism map, Black church committee minutes, student sit-in statement, white county official letter, Black voter-registration data table, Black woman organizer testimony, and federal civil rights legislation/enforcement summary; document perspectives include local Black churches, women organizers, student activists, white southern officials, county registrars, Black voter-registration workers, federal lawmakers, national organizations, and local communities; main argument paths include local institutional organizing, nonviolent direct action, youth activism, women’s leadership, white resistance/local control, voter registration, federal enforcement, and the interaction between grassroots pressure and national law; outside evidence possibilities include *Brown v. Board of Education*, Montgomery Bus Boycott, SNCC, CORE, Freedom Rides, Birmingham campaign, March on Washington, Freedom Summer, Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party, Selma campaign, Civil Rights Act of 1964, Voting Rights Act of 1965, Ella Baker, Fannie Lou Hamer, and Septima Clark; sourcing opportunities include church minutes as logistical community organizing, student statement as youth direct-action perspective, county official’s segregationist local-control argument, organizer testimony as grassroots political education, registration table as evidence of legal/activist effects, and federal legislation summary as response to local resistance; visual/data/map types include described southern civil rights activity map and Black voter-registration data table.

- APUSH-LEQ10-001: Units 4–5; Periods 4–5 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is causes of United States territorial expansion from 1803 to 1853; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include Louisiana Purchase, Lewis and Clark, Adams-Onís Treaty, War of 1812 aftermath, cotton expansion, Texas independence, Texas annexation, Oregon Trail, Manifest Destiny, Mexican-American War, Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo, Mexican Cession, slavery debates, and commercial migration; complexity path is distinguishing diplomatic purchase, treaty, migration, annexation, war, ideology, economic ambition, security concerns, sectional politics, and coercive expansion; misconception targeted is treating Manifest Destiny as the only cause of expansion or portraying expansion as peaceful, inevitable, and uncontested.